Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.
If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.
If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.
Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♦
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣7

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 5♣
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥A

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣4

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦A

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦5

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A J 7 ♥ J 6 ♦ Q J 10 8 7 ♣ A 6 4	
♠ Q 10 4 2 ♥ 10 4 3 ♦ 5 ♣ 10 9 5 3 2	N W E S	♠ K 9 8 5 3 ♥ A 9 5 ♦ 4 2 ♣ J 8 7
	♠ 6 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ A K 9 6 3 ♣ K Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2♦	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	6♦
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♦ by North
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH decides it is unlikely that NORTH is Aceless, so all he wants to know is the number of Aces NORTH does have. He invokes RKC Blackwood.

Since no trump suit has been agreed, NORTH bids as if ♦s, the last-bid suit prior to 4NT is agreed. NORTH has two Key-cards plus the trump Queen, so she bids 5♠.

SOUTH bids 6♦. If NORTH had just one Key-card, SOUTH would bid 5♦ over the 5♣ reply.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 8 5 3 2 ♥ 10 5 4 3 ♦ J 10 ♣ 5 4	
♠ 6 ♥ K Q 8 7 2 ♦ K Q ♣ A K 9 6 3	N W E S	♠ K Q 7 ♥ J 6 ♦ A 6 4 ♣ Q J 10 8 7
	♠ A J 10 4 ♥ A 9 ♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2 ♣ 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2♣	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]	
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 1 or 4 key cards

5♣ by East
Lead: ♥A

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, WEST has no problem as long as EAST holds at least one Key-card. When EAST responds 5♣, (showing one Key-card), WEST can pass.

That's what happens here.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2
♥ 4
♦ K 6
♣ A K 5

♠ 4
♥ 9 7 5 2
♦ 9 5 4 3
♣ 8 7 4 2



♠ 10 3
♥ A K 8 6
♦ 10 8 7 2
♣ 10 6 3

♠ A 9 6
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ A Q J
♣ Q J 9

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

NORTH needs to know how many Aces SOUTH holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 9 6
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ A 10 8 6 2
♣ 10 3

♠ K Q 8 7 4 3
♥ Q 7 5
♦ —
♣ 9 7 6 2



♠ A J 10 5
♥ A K
♦ K 5
♣ A K Q J 4

♠ 2
♥ J 10 9 3
♦ Q J 9 7 4 3
♣ 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♦	Pass	7♠	
All Pass			

7♠ by West
Lead: ♦A

WEST's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

EAST figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

WEST's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

EAST readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

Board 5
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 6 ♥ A Q 8 7 5 2 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ 8 7	
♠ J 8 7 2 ♥ J ♦ J 10 9 8 7 4 ♣ A 3	N W E S	♠ 10 9 5 4 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 5 2 ♣ J 10 5 4 2
	♠ K Q 3 ♥ K 10 9 3 ♦ A 6 ♣ K Q 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♠[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by North
Lead: ♦5

NORTH jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

SOUTH has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

NORTH responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for SOUTH to bid the slam.